She Voters
MANDATE 2024

Inflation Pain

Ulka Kharat, *58*

Lasurne, Maharashtra
Anganwadi worker

Constituency: Baramati

Issues that will decide her vote: Inflation, high LPG prices

Demands from the govt: Reducing inflation, ensuring employment for youth



MANDAR DEODHAR

For Ulka Kharat, a widow living with her brother in Lasurne in Pune's Indapur taluka, inflation matters more than anything else. "LPG cylinders have become exorbitant," she says. "What will the poor do when they cannot make ends meet? The situation of the working class and daily wagers is miserable."

Kharat studied only up to standard VIII, but completed her education and acquired a BA degree at age 50. The one thing she is most concerned about is the job scene for the youth. It looks bleak and they seem to have no future. As for herself, the anganwadi worker says that employees of the childcare scheme must get better remuneration. ■

-Dhaval S. Kulkarni



MADHUSUDHAN SR

S. Chandrakala, *47*

Mysuru, *Shop owner*

Constituency: Mysuru-Kodagu

Issues that will decide her vote: Policies for women like easy access to loans, a performing candidate

Demands from the govt: Schemes for healthcare and education



SANDEEP SAHDEV

For Stability's Sake

A graduate from IIT Roorkee, Goyal has a postgraduate degree from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in the US. The 38-year-old says she will vote "because I care for a stable government".

"I strongly believe that reservation is detrimental to India's progress and should be eliminated at all levels"

Goyal adds that there is no better candidate than Prime Minister Narendra Modi currently, especially in the absence of a strong opposition. "Therefore, I will vote for him, as he has elevated India's position on the global stage, taken a firm stand against terrorism," she says. "Things are not as bad as they used to be," she adds.

She also praises the PM for the abolition of Triple Talaq in 2019 and helping improve the position of Muslim women. ■

-Sonal Khetarpal

Manju Goyal, *38*

Hyderabad

Technology head at a consultancy firm

Constituency: North West Delhi

Issues that will decide her vote: Growth, prosperity and stability of the country, planning for India's future

Demands from the govt: Women's empowerment, population control, mitigating climate change